



Cheers at a watch party at the San Diego Air & Space Museum on Friday after Artemis II splashed down in the Pacific Ocean.

Mission to the Moon Inspires a Sense of Reverence

By RUTH GRAHAM

In the beginning, Artemis II was about science. The mission, which ended on Friday with a clean splash into the Pacific Ocean, carried four astronauts who gathered data, took photographs and tested life support systems as they orbited the moon. But for the astronauts themselves, and millions of people who checked in on them from hundreds of thousands of miles away, the mission also elicited meditations on more profound matters.

“You just look up and feel wonder, grandeur and smallness at the same time,” said Jim Davis, a pastor in Orlando, Fla. He was having dinner at a restaurant with a small group from his church when the mis-

Chance to Ponder Our Power, and Our Powerlessness

sion launched on April 1. The group stepped out into the parking lot to admire the rocket blasting upward into the early evening sky. For 10 days, people admired the vastness of the universe. The frailty and interdependence of the human species. The sheer awesomeness of the moon.

“I just had an overwhelming sense of being moved by looking at the moon,” Christina Koch, a mission specialist on Artemis II, reported to mission control last week. “It lasted just a second or two, and I

actually couldn’t even make it happen again, but something just threw me in suddenly to the lunar landscape and it became real.”

For many people back home on Earth, the mission was a brief reminder of the sheer scale of outer space, and a prompt to contemplate both our power and our powerlessness. It turned all of us into children at camp, lying supine and looking up at the stars, thinking very big thoughts.

It’s a paradox that scientists, philosophers and poets have tried to capture for centuries.

“When I look at your heavens, the work of your fingers, the moon and the stars that you have established, what are humans that

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Vance Leads Negotiations To End War He Opposed

Vice President Faces High-Profile Test of Diplomatic Skills With Iran Talks

By KATIE ROGERS and TYLER PAGER

WASHINGTON — Weeks after Vice President JD Vance privately warned President Trump of the costs of a full-scale U.S. war with Iran, he is now leading the charge to negotiate an end to the biggest foreign policy crisis that the president has faced during his time in office.

Mr. Vance began peace talks with top Iranian officials on Saturday in Islamabad, Pakistan, as a cease-fire between the two countries was under strain. It was the highest-level face-to-face meeting between U.S. and Iranian officials since Iran’s 1979 Islamic Revolution, which put the two countries on a collision course.

The vice president was joined by, among others, Steve Witkoff, the president’s special envoy, and Jared Kushner, Mr. Trump’s son-in-law, who led a failed round of negotiations in February.

The stakes are enormous for Mr. Trump and for Mr. Vance, whose most high-profile assignments from Mr. Trump have involved domestic politics, most recently as the president’s “fraud czar.”

Before the war began, the vice president was planning to be heavily focused on traveling the country ahead of the midterm elections, counteracting widespread concerns over the cost of living and affordability by attacking Democrats as out of touch and politically extreme. The war has upended that messaging. An Iranian blockade around the Strait of Hormuz, a key oil route, has sent

energy prices soaring.

“Knowing that this is a midterm election year, that is the biggest leverage point that the Iranians have, and they know that,” said Marc Short, who served as chief of staff to Vice President Mike Pence, Mr. Vance’s predecessor from Mr. Trump’s first term. “That creates a challenge for the president’s negotiating team.”

He added: “There’s a best-case scenario that you have successful talks, and you have a great news cycle about it. But doesn’t Iran know that they can break the terms, as they have in the past?”

Mr. Vance, 41, has stayed largely at the periphery of other high-stakes foreign policy missions, including the operation to seize Nicolás Maduro and depose him as Venezuela’s leader. He was traveling in Azerbaijan in February when Benjamin Netanyahu, the prime minister of Israel, delivered a presentation requesting U.S. involvement in a war with Iran.

On Tuesday, as the president, in Washington, threatened to wipe out the Iranian civilization, Mr. Vance was in Hungary, stumping for Viktor Orban, the country’s nationalist prime minister.

He is now leading the effort to persuade Iranians to keep the strait open even as the Israelis continue a bombing campaign against Iran-backed Hezbollah in Lebanon, a fight that the United States has said is not part of the current cease-fire agreement but

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BROKERING PEACE American officials and Iranian negotiators met in a historic encounter between decades-old adversaries. PAGE 10

DEVASTATION The vast scale of destruction in Iran will make relief from sanctions all the more important to the government. PAGE 12



Eager to Return to the Land
At the Okie Homesteading Expo, attendees learned how to be prepared if disaster strikes. Page 13.

Northeastern States Scale Down Climate Goals

By BRAD PLUMER

Several years ago, in a burst of climate optimism, Democratic-led states across the Northeast adopted some of the world’s most ambitious policies to shift away from fossil fuels and cut planet-warming emissions.

But today, many of those states are scaling back or rethinking their climate plans as they miss emissions targets, struggle with soaring electricity bills and confront the Trump administration’s hostility to renewable energy.

In New York, Gov. Kathy

Blaming Energy Costs and Trump’s Policies

Hochul recently said the state’s goal for deeply cutting emissions by 2030 was now “unattainable” and asked the Legislature to rework its landmark climate law. Regulators had been discussing fees on polluters to help meet that goal, but Ms. Hochul said the costs passed onto consumers would be too high.

In Massachusetts, lawmakers

are eyeing cuts to a program that adds charges to utility bills to fund heat pumps and efficiency upgrades, while Gov. Maura Healey has pursued a flurry of energy policy changes to address affordability.

In Rhode Island, Gov. Dan McKee has proposed delaying a legal deadline for the state to get all of its electricity from renewables, from 2033 to 2050, claiming that the current mandate would impose steep near-term costs.

“The biggest hardship I hear from Rhode Islanders right now is

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Democrats Flee From Swalwell Over a Scandal

By LAUREL ROSENHALL and MADISON MALONE KIRCHER

SACRAMENTO — Representative Eric Swalwell of California was facing calls this weekend to drop out of the governor’s race as key Democratic supporters abandoned him amid mounting accusations of sexual assault and misconduct.

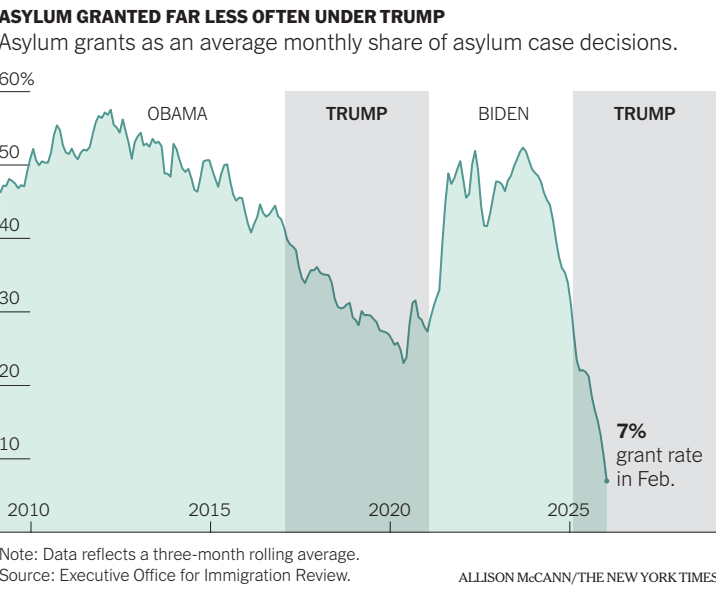
The San Francisco Chronicle published an account Friday from a woman who was not named but gave detailed descriptions of several sexual encounters she said she had with Mr. Swalwell, including two instances in which she said he had assaulted her when she was too intoxicated to consent.

She said one of them occurred in New York City, and on Saturday, the Manhattan district attorney’s office said it was opening an investigation.

CNN published a report on Friday with four women accusing Mr. Swalwell of a range of misconduct, including a former staff member who appeared to be the same person in The Chronicle’s account. CNN’s report also described allegations from a Democratic activist who said Mr. Swalwell had touched her thigh and tried to kiss her in the booth of a bar before bringing her to his hotel room, and from two women who said he had sent them unsolicited photos of his penis.

Mr. Swalwell immediately denied the accusations and said later on Friday that he would continue to fight them.

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Immigration Judges Are Purged As Trump Speeds Deportations

This article is by Nicholas Nehamas, Allison McCann, Steven Rich, Jazmine Ulloa and Hamed Aleaziz.

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration has systematically pressured the nation’s immigration judges, threatening them with disciplinary action if they do not deport more people and firing those seen as insufficiently supportive of the president’s aggressive enforcement agenda, a New York Times investigation has found.

The overhaul of the immigration courts has been far less visible than the militarized deportation raids that President Trump scaled back after public protest. But the effort has helped reshape a hugely consequential, if little-known, corner of the government that the administration is har-

nessing to advance its mass-deportation policies.

Although they wear robes and are required by law to exercise “independent judgment,” immigration judges are not part of the judicial branch. Instead they work for the Justice Department, under Mr. Trump’s ultimate command, and can be fired. One of their main duties is deciding whether undocumented immigrants should be deported or granted a form of legal status like asylum and be allowed to remain in the country.

So far, the Trump administration has dismissed more than 100 immigration judges out of about 750 in place when Mr. Trump returned to power, an unprecedented purge.

At the same time, the administration has reshaped the immigration bench, announcing the ap-

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From a Rebel to a Mascot

Lu Xun, a Mao-era writer who took on the establishment, has been remade into a Disney-style character. PAGE 4

Loyalists Are Deserting Orban

With Hungary’s prime minister seeming vulnerable before Sunday’s election, criticism of him is growing. PAGE 6

NATIONAL 13-23

Pressure on Postal Service

A Trump executive order, which has been challenged as unconstitutional, would restrict sending mail ballots only to voters deemed eligible. PAGE 21



METROPOLITAN

Preserving Political Clout

The Rev. Al Sharpton, seeking to leave his mark, moved a longtime civil rights group to a new home in Harlem. PAGE 1

How to Steal a Subway Car

An inside look at “conquering,” where vandals break into the control booth, and maybe take a joyride. PAGE 1

ARTS & LEISURE

He Turned a Urinal Into Art

Marcel Duchamp, who changed the face of culture in the 20th century, is showcased in a MoMA retrospective. PAGE 12

Reflections of ‘Euphoria’

The show’s creator discusses the soul-searching that went into making the third season of the HBO series. PAGE 8

SUNDAY BUSINESS

Rich and Ridiculously Happy

Lauren Sánchez Bezos, the partner of one of the world’s most powerful men, seems to have influenced the uber-rich to start enjoying themselves. PAGE 6



SPORTS 24-27

Keeping With Tradition

Photographing a week of pageantry at the 90th Masters. Above, Davis Riley playing out of a bunker. PAGE 24

SUNDAY STYLES

Focusing on Femininity

The photographer Petra Collins tells a shadowy story of fame, fandom and girlhood in her new book. PAGE 9

Alarm Over a Gen Z Drink

Experts worry that BuzzBallz, a brand of premixed cocktail, is a magnet for underage drinkers. PAGE 1

SUNDAY OPINION

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